

Mascara

The grey-haired wolf peered upon the stool beside her dressing table, decorated with ornate flowers. Although age had crept upon her, adding sprinklings of white through her pure grey, she believed that the years had' been kind to her.

Her amber eyes were still bright and clear while health remained strong in her coat. Seventy-two and going strong, as Graham would have said.

It had been a long time since she had seen Graham.

Leaning in close to the mirror, she surveyed her reflection with a critical, narrowed eye. No, that simply would not do. She

could not possibly go into town looking as she did.

The pink make-up bag sat where it always had on the right hand side of the table, beside the illuminated, round mirror, which stood alone. She had never used the mirror but it was a gift from her son nine birthdays ago, so she felt obligated to keep it. The magnified glass brought out too many flaws in her fur for her liking.

Digging into the pink bag, she frowned as she hunted down the mascara wand. It evaded her fingers, falling deeper beneath a bundle of lipstick tubes, and she muttered under her breath,

words that she would not have any other fur hear her saying. Finally, she tapped it with a manicured nail and withdrew the slender rod with a triumphant flourish.

"Thought you could get away from me, did you?"

Smiling, she pulled off the cap with a small 'pop' and raised the muffled wand to eye level. She opened her eyes wide and applied the brush to her grey eyelashes, darkening them to a jet sheer. Building on the base she created, the wolf lengthened them, drawing out each ~~hair~~ lash to a fine tip. She parted her lips as she worked, brow furrowed in concentration.

She worked on the top and bottom lashes in turn before dedicating herself ~~to~~ to her left-eye. This time, her lips clamped together in a thin line and she shuffled closer to the mirror, ~~her~~ paw trembling faintly. Each shaky ~~stroke~~ stroke painted greater definition into the lashes, evening out the repaid appearance of her ~~new~~ muzzle.

Alas, her paw faltered and left a splotch of mascara half on her upper lashes and half on her eyelid, marring the look.

"Fuck!"

She glared at her reflection, thinking dully back at her, the black spot of mascara a glaring error.

She ^{huffed} ~~sighed~~ and ^{flung} ~~threw~~ the uncapped
mascara wand on the table, letting
it splatter the surface. Taking
a fresh wipe from the blue
'PAWS' brand make-up remover
packet, she slapped it across
her eyes, half removing and
half smearing ~~the~~ her work.
More delicately, she breathed in
and carefully wiped off every
trace of perfectionism until no
evidence remained. Once clear,
she retrieved the wand and began
again.

Appearances were not worth it
if they were ~~imperfect~~ imperfect.

